

FinCEN SAR Platform

End-User Guide

This guide is written for analysts, reviewers, approvers, and administrators who use the web application day to day.

Who This Guide Is For

Use this guide if you need to:

- Sign in and navigate the platform
- Create and manage SAR filing batches
- Add and complete SAR activities
- Move filings through review and submission statuses
- Resolve common user-facing issues

If you are looking for developer setup, API details, or deployment steps, use [README.md](#).

Quick Start (2 Minutes)

1. Open the web app: `http://localhost:3000`
2. Sign in with your assigned account
3. Open **Batches** from the left menu
4. Select + **New Batch**
5. Add at least one activity and complete the wizard
6. Use workflow actions to move the batch forward

Default local training account:

- Username: `admin`
 - Password: `Admin123!`
-

Application Tour

Left Sidebar

- **Dashboard**: system snapshot and recent work
- **Batches**: create, search, and open filing batches
- **Sign Out**: end your session safely

Main Workspace

- Header: current page and context
- Action buttons: create, delete, workflow actions
- Data tables: sortable/paginated records
- Status badges: current filing state

Filing Statuses

- **DRAFT** : actively being prepared
- **REVIEW** : ready for reviewer/approver check
- **SUBMITTED** : sent for filing workflow completion

- **ACKNOWLEDGED** : accepted/finalized
 - **REJECTED** : returned due to issues
-

Core Workflow

1. Create a Batch

1. Go to **Batches**
2. Select + **New Batch**
3. Enter:
 - **Activity Count**
 - **Party Count**
 - **Total Amount** (optional)
4. Select **Create Batch**

Expected result:

- You are redirected to the new batch detail page
- Batch starts in **DRAFT**

2. Add Activities to the Batch

1. Open the batch detail page
2. Select **Add Activity**
3. Open the activity wizard

Each activity is a single SAR report record.

3. Complete the Activity Wizard

The wizard has 9 sections. You can move between sections as needed.

1. **Activity Header**
2. **Filing Type**
3. **Support Document**
4. **Parties**
5. **Suspicious Activity**
6. **IP Addresses**
7. **Cyber Events**
8. **Assets**
9. **Narratives**

Good practice:

- Save complete, accurate values per section
- Use realistic dates and required party details
- Keep narratives clear, factual, and chronological

4. Submit Through Filing Workflow

From the batch detail page, use workflow buttons according to your role:

- **Submit for Review:** **DRAFT** to **REVIEW**
- **Return to Draft:** **REVIEW** to **DRAFT**
- **Submit to FinCEN:** **REVIEW** to **SUBMITTED**
- **Acknowledge:** **SUBMITTED** to **ACKNOWLEDGED**

- **Reject:** SUBMITTED to REJECTED

Role-Based Access (What You Can Do)

Capability	Analyst	Reviewer	Approver	Admin
Create/edit batches	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Create/edit activities	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Delete records	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Submit for review	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Return to draft	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
Submit to FinCEN	No	No	Yes	Yes
Acknowledge or reject	No	No	Yes	Yes
Manage users	No	No	No	Yes

If a button is missing or disabled, your account role likely does not allow that action.

Data Entry Guidance

Required vs Optional

- Required fields must be completed before successful workflow progression
- Optional fields improve filing quality but may not block saving

Dates

- Use real event and filing dates
- Avoid future dates for filing/event records unless explicitly intended

Narrative Quality

A strong narrative includes:

- Who was involved
- What happened
- When it happened
- Why it is suspicious
- Dollar values and transaction patterns

Party Records

Ensure party type is correct before entering details. Different party types require different supporting data.

Tips for Faster Work

- Use batch filters to focus on one status at a time
- Open recent batches from Dashboard for quick continuation

- Complete one activity fully before starting the next
 - Re-check **REVIEW** items for missing or inconsistent details
-

Common Tasks

Open an Existing Batch

1. Go to **Batches**
2. Filter or page to locate the record
3. Select the batch ID link

Delete a Batch

1. Locate the batch in **Batches**
2. Select **Delete**
3. Confirm the prompt

Warning: deleting a batch also deletes its activities and nested records.

Download XML (If Available)

On batch detail, select the XML download action when the filing is ready.

Troubleshooting

"502 Bad Gateway" in Browser

What it means:

- The web server is up, but API was temporarily unreachable

What to do:

1. Wait 20-40 seconds and refresh
2. Verify local services are running
3. Sign in again if your session expired

"403" or "Unauthorized"

What it means:

- You are not authenticated or your role cannot perform the action

What to do:

1. Sign out and sign in again
2. Verify you are using the correct role
3. Retry action from the intended status (for workflow transitions)

"Create Batch" appears to do nothing

What to check:

1. Confirm required numeric fields are valid
2. Look for error banner near the form
3. Re-authenticate if session is stale

Session Keeps Expiring

- This is usually expected token expiration behavior
 - Sign in again to continue
-

FAQ

Can I edit submitted filings?

Typically no. Move back to **DRAFT** first (if your role allows), then edit.

Why are workflow buttons missing?

Buttons are status-based and role-based. Both conditions must allow the action.

How many narratives can I add?

Up to 5 narrative blocks per activity.

Best Practices Checklist

Before moving a batch to **REVIEW** :

- All required activity fields complete
- Parties and suspicious activity sections reviewed
- Narrative is clear and complete
- Dates and amounts are internally consistent

Before **SUBMITTED** :

- Reviewer comments resolved
 - No validation warnings remain
 - Batch contents are final
-

Keyboard and Accessibility Notes

- Use **Tab** and **Shift+Tab** to move through fields
 - Use browser zoom for readability as needed
 - Use clear contrast mode/settings in your browser or OS for visual comfort
-

Need Help

If you are blocked:

1. Capture the page, action attempted, and exact error text
 2. Share your user role and batch ID
 3. Contact your system administrator or support team
-

Document Information

- Product: FinCEN SAR Filing Platform
- Audience: End users (Analyst, Reviewer, Approver, Admin)

- Version date: March 16, 2026